

Off-Leash Area Expansion Study Recommendations

Board of Parks and Recreation Commissioners

Presenters:

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Seattle
Parks & Recreation

Healthy People, Thriving Environment, Vibrant Community





How We Got Here

- Began with 32 possible sites that were taken through site selection criteria and SPR internal ProView review
- 9 sites were determined to meet SPR basic OLA criteria
- June 2023, present to BPRC, launch public information and survey campaign
- July & August attend 3 farmers markets throughout the city to engage with park users and push survey.
- September thru November, synthesize 4753 survey responses and prepared recommendations for first 3 new OLA sites

Recommendation #1: West Seattle Stadium



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- 1976 people responded to the site
- **1720 (87%)** in support
- 256 (13%) in opposition
- Top supporting comments: density of surrounding area, walkability/transit access, current use as parking
- Top opposing comments: concerns with parking at the site, safety of driveway and entrance from 35th Ave SW



Recommendation #2: Othello Park



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- 711 people responded to the site
- **518 (73%)** in support
- 193 (27%) in opposition
- Top supporting comments: Park is within an urban village with increasing density, close to transit/light rail, ~3 miles from nearest current OLA
- Top opposing comments: Parts of the park host regular events, no dedicated off-street parking

Recommendation #3: Ravenna Park



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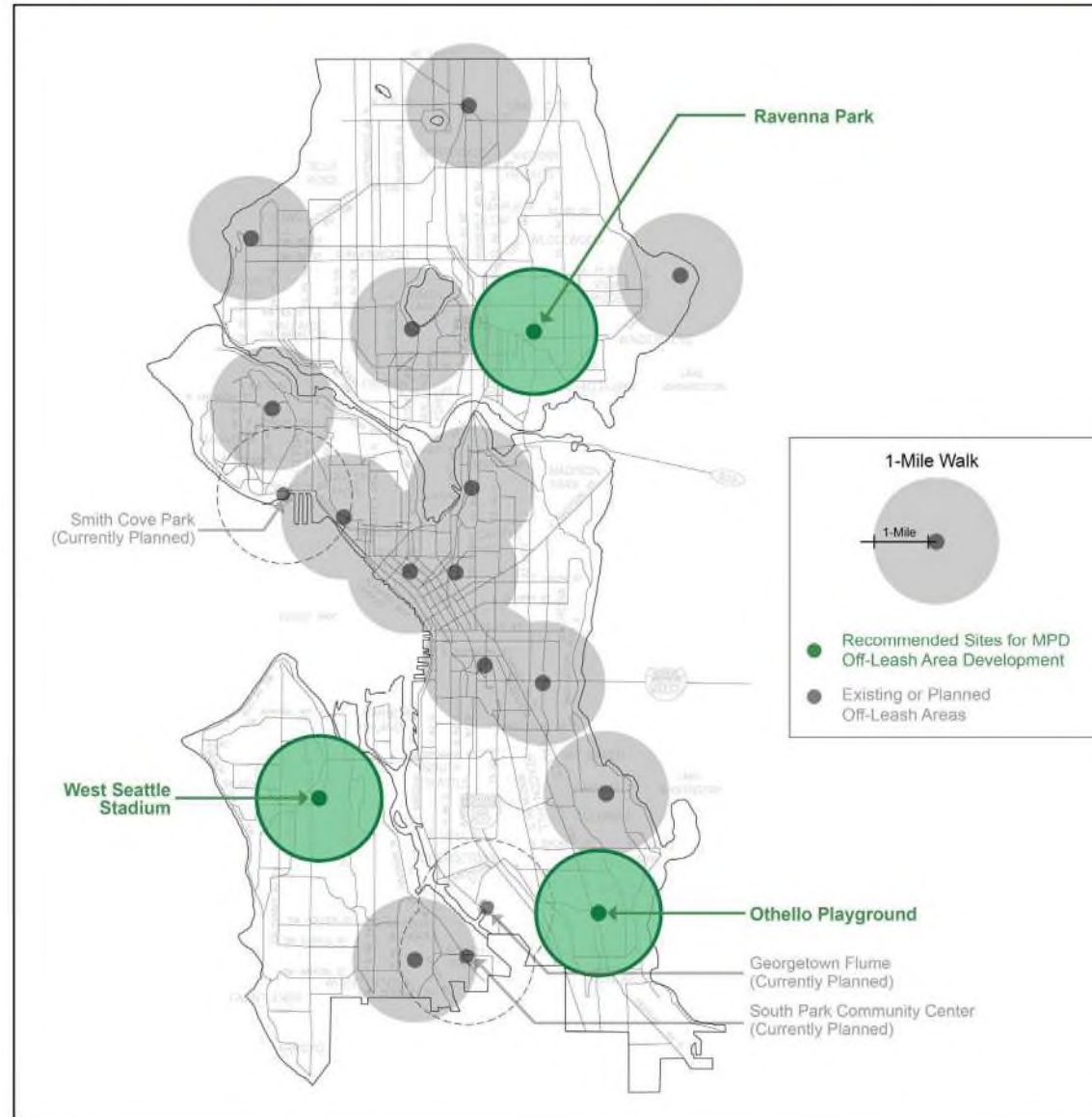


Recommendation #3: Ravenna Park

- 1058 people responded to the site
- **648 (61%)** in support
- 410 (39%) in opposition
- Top supporting comments: area already experiencing unsanctioned off leash activity, park adjacent to 2 urban villages with increasing density, no immediately bordering uses
- Top opposing comments: limited parking, natural character of the park



Map of current sites + Recommendations



Findings on the six remaining sites

Additional sites recommended for future OLAs:

- Brighton Playfield
 - Alternative location in the park needs to be identified for sand volleyball court
- East Queen Anne Playfield
 - Further discussions with community needed on field scheduling capacity

Findings on the six remaining sites

Sites that should be removed from consideration:

- Discovery Park
 - Concerns about environmental impacts as well as community uses at the site
- Powell-Barnett Park
 - Community use of the site
- View Ridge Playfield
 - Potential disruption of existing playfield activities due to close proximity; low priority area due to nearby Magnuson OLA
- Lincoln Park
 - Community prefers passive activation at this site

Next Steps

- Present recommended sites for three funding pockets to the Board of Parks and Recreation Commissioners on 2/22/24
- Public comment and review/approval by BPRC on 3/14/24
- SPR Superintendent approves BPRC recommendations

After approval of recommendations:

- Engage with local area for selected sites in Summer 2024
- Begin preliminary OLA Design/Review for selected sites
 - Begin design for West Seattle & Othello Park site in Summer/Fall 2024
 - Funding for full design and construction available in 2025 and 2026
 - Develop design of Ravenna Park site in 2027/28
 - Current MPD budget only includes funding for design of 3rd OLA



Future OLA Expansion Options

- Explore creative solutions to address gaps
 - Examples include Capitol Hill, Ballard, Northgate
- Focus on dense, walkable neighborhood sites rather than large scale destinations
- Explore partnerships within the city and with other public agencies, beyond SPR sites
- Explore policy changes that allow for expanded access to OLAs
- With expanding OLA system, expanded enforcement of leash laws is needed

Thank you!



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